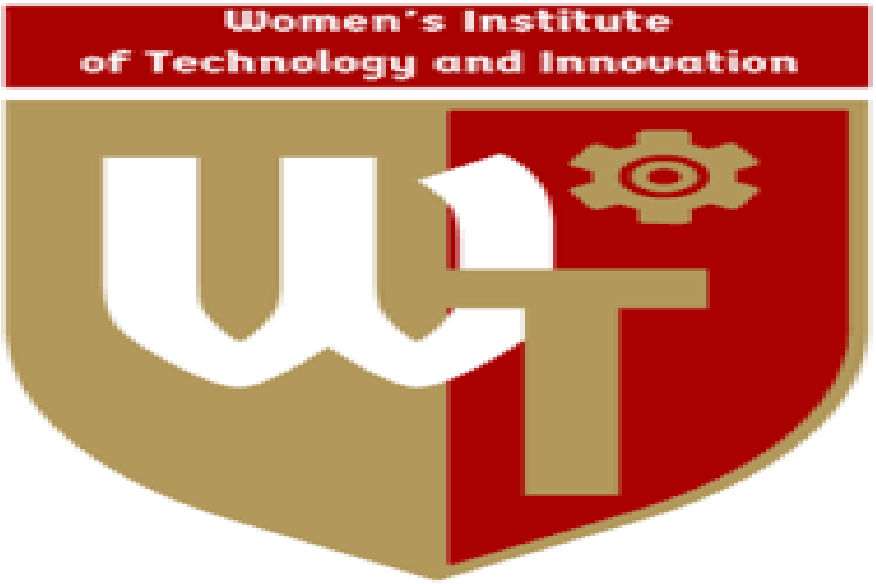

PROJECT TITLE: Zula's Chicken a Modern Digital Showcase for Contemporary Uganda Fusion Cuisine

A Project Proposal Submitted to the Women's Institute of Technology and Innovation for the Study Leading to a Project in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Award of the Diploma in Computer Science.

WOMENS' INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATION
Plot 12, Corporation Rise, Bukoto, Kampala-Uganda

Table of Contents

Chapter 1 3
1.0 Introduction 3
1.2 Background and Justification 3
Problem statement 4
Objectives 4
General Objective: 4
Specific Objectives: 4
Project scope 5
Significance of the project 5
Chapter 2 7
Literature Review 7
Chapter 3 8
Time Frame 10
7. Budget 11
Chapter 4 12
Risk management 12
References 13
Appendices 14

Zula's Chicken a Modern Digital Showcase for Contemporary Uganda Fusion Cuisine

By

: KIDENI JIMIA & BRIGHT JEMIMMAH

DIPLOMA IN COMPUTER SCIENCE
WOMENS' INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATION

A **Project Proposal** Submitted to the Women's Institute of Technology and Innovation for the Study Leading to a Project in Zula's Chicken a Modern Digital Showcase for Contemporary Uganda Fusion Cuisine

Supervisor

Madam Tugume Brenda
Women's Institute of Technology and Innovation

11th June, 2025

Chapter 1

1.0 Introduction

In today's digital age, having an online presence is essential for businesses of all types including those in the food industry. In Uganda, the culinary landscape is undergoing a transformation as traditional meals are being modernized to suit evolving urban tastes. One such meal is the Lusaniya popular shared platter that reflects Uganda's rich food culture. Despite its growing popularity, many Lusaniya vendors operate with minimal digital visibility, relying mainly on word-of-mouth and informal platforms like WhatsApp for customer engagement.

This project aims to bridge that gap by developing a modern, interactive website for **Zula's Chicken**, a contemporary Lusaniya food business. The website will not only showcase the vendor's diverse menu including traditional dishes and modern snacksbut also simulate an online ordering experience. As a student academic project, it demonstrates how digital tools can be applied to promote and support local food businesses in a practical and cost-effective way.

Through this initiative, we aim to highlight the importance of digital innovation in promoting Ugandan cuisine while building technical skills in web design, development, and user experience.

1.2 Background and Justification

Uganda's food scene has evolved, blending traditional dishes with modern twists. The lusaniya platter once communal local meal has become a vibrant and diverse mix flavors often featuring chapatis, pilau, chicken, chips, beef, goat's meat, vegetables, salads and sauce, served in a shared tray. It's enjoyed widely by youth, working class individuals, students and families, making it both a cultural and social experience.

However, most lusaniya vendors rely on words of mouth and WhatsApp marketing with limited digital presence, missing out on broader customer reach. The goal of this student recess project is to build a professional user-friendly website to represent a lusaniya food point, showcasing its diverse

menu, snacks and ordering information. This is not a commercial venture, but a practical academic project that demonstrates the power of digital tools in food business promotion.

Problem statement

Despite the increasing popularity of Lusaniya meals among youth, working professionals, and families in Uganda, many vendors in this niche continue to operate without a strong digital presence. Most rely heavily on informal marketing channels such as word-of-mouth and WhatsApp, which significantly limits their reach and customer engagement in a digitally driven market.

This lack of online visibility prevents potential customers especially tech-savvy individuals from easily accessing information about menus, prices, location, or making orders. As a result, Lusaniya vendors miss opportunities for growth, brand recognition, and customer interaction that a digital platform can offer.

Therefore, there is a need to develop a modern, visually appealing, and informative website for a Lusaniya food business like **Zula's Chicken**. This digital showcase will help bridge the gap between traditional food service and modern customer expectations, using technology to promote local cuisine and enhance customer accessibility.

Objectives

General Objective:

To design and develop a visually appealing, informative website for a modern lusaniya food business

Specific Objectives:

- To showcase the lusaniya menu with options like chicken, chapatis, pilau and chips
- To simulate an online ordering system for academic demonstration and sales increase for the business.
- To include a snack corner section with light meals like samosa, chapati wraps, sausage

- To offer location or contact details and storytelling of the food culture.
- To explore potential use of digital tools like domain, web hosting in promoting local cuisine

Project scope

This website will be fully implemented and used by the business thought the project is worked on as a part of the school requirement. The platform will serve as the restaurant's official online presence, helping to attract customers, share menus and communicate with clients.

The project includes:

A responsive website optimized for both desktop and mobile use

- Menu display showing main business dishes
- snack section with quick options like Rolex samosas etc.
- contact and ordering information including directions, phone numbers and links to social media handles
- photo gallery featuring real images of meals to entire customers.
- About page introducing the business and its background

This project excludes:

- Online payment processing
- Automatic delivery tracking or kitchen management systems.

However, the website is designed in such a way that these features can be added in the future if needed

Significance of the project

This project holds significance on multiple levels academic, technological, and socio-economic:

Academic Significance

As a student project, it provides hands-on experience in applying web development skills such as HTML, CSS, React.js, and Python to solve real-world challenges. It also encourages innovation and creativity in using digital tools to support local businesses.

Technological Significance

The website will serve as a modern digital platform showcasing the capabilities of technology in promoting small-scale enterprises. It demonstrates how web-based solutions can enhance customer engagement, increase visibility, and streamline communication between vendors and clients.

Business and Social Impact

For **Zula's Chicken**, the website will act as a cost-effective tool for marketing and customer outreach. It offers an opportunity for the business to connect with a wider audience, especially urban and tech-savvy consumers. Socially, the project contributes to preserving and promoting Ugandan culinary traditions by presenting them in a modern, accessible format.

Scalability and Future Use

The project lays the foundation for future digital enhancements such as online ordering, payment integration, and delivery tracking. It provides a scalable model that other small food vendors in Uganda can replicate to boost their digital transformation journey.

Chapter 2
Literature Review

With increasing smartphone usage and access in Uganda, many customers expect businesses especially in the food industry to have an online presence. Research by GSMA 2023 shows that over 75% of Ugandan youth access social media or web daily. A digital platform can boost visibility, streamline customer communication and help even small restaurant compete with bigger establishments

Studies from hospitality research journals emphasize how digital menus, food photography and customer reviews influence purchase behavior. While apps like jumia Food dominate in urban centers, they often overlook traditional or small-scale vendors. A focused, custom-built website is more affordable and effective for niche markets like lusaniya vendors.

.

Chapter 3
Methodologies/activities

1. **Data Collection**

   The project begins with interviews conducted with the Lusaniya food vendor to gather detailed information about the menu, target customers, and the overall branding vision. This step helps define the content and functional requirements needed for the website.

2. **Wireframing & Planning**

   A visual layout of the website is designed using basic sketches or digital wireframing tools. This phase focuses on planning the structure, user interface, and navigation to ensure a logical and smooth user experience.

3. **Web Design & Development**

   The website is built using HTML and CSS for structure and styling, React.js for dynamic frontend features, and Python where applicable for backend functions. The design ensures responsiveness, making the site accessible on both desktop and mobile devices.

4. **Image Integration**

   High-quality images of actual meals and snacks are captured and embedded into the website. These visuals help attract users and provide an authentic representation of the food being offered.

5. **Snack Point Page**

   A dedicated page is created to showcase quick snack options such as samosas, chapati wraps, and sausages. This section expands the menu and appeals to customers seeking light meals.

6. **Testing & Feedback**

   The completed website is tested by peers, instructors, and the vendor. Any identified bugs or usability issues are corrected, and feedback is incorporated to improve functionality and user satisfaction.

7. **Deployment**

   Once finalized, the website is deployed on a free hosting platform, ensuring it is live and accessible to users. Performance is optimized to maintain speed and usability.

8. **Documentation**

   A full project report is compiled, including screenshots of the site, reflections on the development process, challenges encountered, and lessons learned. This documentation meets academic requirements and supports future updates.

Time Frame

Week	Dates	Activity Description
Week 1	17th – 23rd June	Requirement gathering and vendor interview
Week 2	24th – 30th June	Wireframing and layout design
Week 3 – 4	1st – 14th July	Website development using HTML, CSS, React.js, and Python
Week 5	15th – 21st July	Content population – menu items, photos, and details
Week 6	22nd – 28th July	Testing with vendor and fixing bugs
Week 7	29th July – 4th Aug	Deploying to hosting platform
Week 8	5th – 11th Aug	Final presentation and report submission

7. Budget

Item	Estimated Cost (UGX)
Domain registration (1 year)	150,000
Website hosting (1 year)	100,000
Internet for development (data bundles)	50,000
Total	**300,000**

The domain will allow the business to have a professional URL, increasing customer trust and visibility

Chapter 4

Risk management

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Internet disruption	Use offline development tools when needed and sync updates when online. Maintain backup copies of all work regularly.
Unavailability of vendor input	Use placeholder content temporarily and update once vendor feedback is available. Maintain regular communication with the vendor.
Poor image quality	Arrange for professional or high-quality photos and videos taken directly at the business location to ensure authenticity.
Website bugs or downtime	Conduct regular testing during development; promptly fix bugs and perform routine maintenance to ensure website reliability.

9. Sustainability

The project is designed using open-source tools and clean maintainable code, which ensures low operating costs and high sustainability. Future updates like adding online ordering or payment can be easily integrated. The vendor will also be trained on how to update the website content or seek help when needed.

10. Conclusion

This project demonstrates how Lusaniya food vendor offering modern, affordable Ugandan meals can benefit from digital platform. Although created as a student recess project, the website will be used actively by the business to boost visibility, attract new customers and showcase its offerings. With minimal setup costs and no ongoing hosting fees for now bringing forward both practical and scalable solutions.

References

1. GSMA. (2023). *The Mobile Economy Sub-Saharan Africa 2023*. Retrieved from https://www.gsma.com/mobileeconomy/

2. Mugisha, A. (2022). *The Rise of Digital Menus and Their Impact on Small Restaurants in Uganda*. Journal of Hospitality & Tourism Innovation, 14(3), 122–135.

3. Jumia Group. (2023). *Jumia Food Usage Report: Trends in Online Food Ordering in Uganda*. Retrieved from https://group.jumia.com

4. Nansubuga, R., & Kalema, R. (2021). *Adoption of E-Commerce Platforms by Small Businesses in Kampala*. Makerere University Business Review, 9(1), 45–57

1. Tumusiime, D. (2020). *Digital Tools for SMEs in Uganda: Opportunities and Challenges*. ICT for Development Journal, 6(2), 75–88.

Appendices

Appendix A: Interview Questions with Vendor

- List of questions asked to understand menu items, customer preferences, and business goals.

Appendix B: Wireframe Designs

- Initial sketches and digital mockups showing the planned website layout and navigation.

Appendix C: Sample Menu Content

- Full text of menu descriptions, prices, and any special offers included on the website.

Appendix D: Image Gallery

- High-quality photos of meals, snacks, and the restaurant environment used in the project.

Appendix E: Testing Feedback Forms

- Copies of feedback collected from peers, instructors, and the vendor during usability testing.

Appendix F: Code Snippets

- Selected portions of HTML, CSS, React.js, and Python code demonstrating key features